

With companies creating more decentralised products and services, blockchain technology is expected to gain momentum this year. The development of more sustainable and energy-efficient proof-of-stake blockchain technologies as a replacement for the earlier energy-intensive proof-of-work ones is also fuelling its growth. NFTs are bound to grow—as the means of interacting with many digital products and services, and as an accepted form of contracts, such as NFT concert tickets, or NFTs as ‘certificates’ to prove ownership of rare physical objects. Web3 also boasts of financial freedom. DeFi enables anyone to engage in financial activities. Web3 predominantly uses cryptocurrencies, although digital equivalents of fiat currencies are also being slowly integrated.

Observability and the digital immune system

Application performance monitoring (APM) is slowly giving way to ‘observability.’ Monitoring helps you watch a system’s performance—based on pre-defined metrics and logs—to detect known failures. That does not sound so smart in this age of AI, right? On the other hand, observability is all about anticipating problems, understanding their root causes, and actively debugging them.

According to data platform Splunk, “A system is considered ‘observable’ if the current state can be estimated by only using information from outputs, namely sensor data. While it might seem like a recent buzzword, the term originated decades ago with control theory (which is about describing and understanding self-regulating systems). However, it has increasingly been applied to improving the performance of distributed IT systems.”

APM cannot keep pace with the increased use of agile development,



The superapps are coming! (Courtesy: Gartner)

DevOps, microservices, multiple programming languages, serverless and other cloud-native technologies. It is very difficult to trace a problem to its origin in such distributed systems. Teams need to understand not just one application but the full picture, including its many interdependencies, in order to proactively identify and fix potential problems. Observability platforms and tools like IBM Instana Observability, Splunk, Datadog, Dynatrace, New Relic, and OpenTelemetry enable them to do this.

Observability is a crucial aspect of the emerging concept of digital immune system (DIS). According to Gartner, the DIS approach includes practices and technologies for software design, development, automation, operation, and analytics, and uses these to create a superior user experience and to reduce system failures that impact business performance. DISs interlink practices from the areas of observability, software testing, chaos engineering, site

reliability engineering, and supply chain security of applications.

Superapps

In a Gartner blog, contributor Lori Perri compares a superapp to a Swiss knife, as it comprises a range of component tools (miniapps) that the user can use and remove as needed. A superapp provides end-users with core functionality or features, along with access to independently-developed mini-apps. At a simple plane, you can look at it as a single portal, which hosts multiple miniapps covering various aspects like messaging, collaboration, payments, etc. Users can pick and choose the miniapps they want and get a consolidated, seamless view of these, somewhat like their personalised platform.

Gartner estimates that 15 popular superapps have been downloaded more than 4.6 billion times around the world, with 2.68 billion monthly active users. It predicts that, by 2027, more than 50 % of